

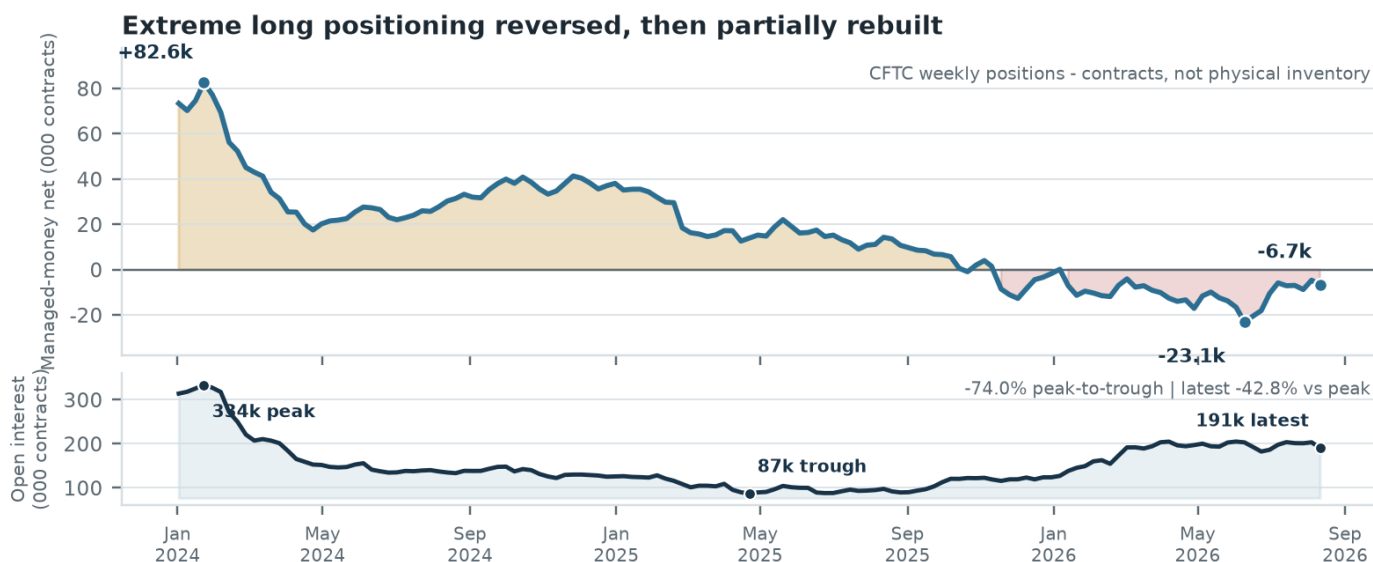
Cocoa Positioning Regime Shift

From the 2024 positioning extreme to the 2026 rebuild

Cutoff: Aug 14, 2026, 15:31 ET

VIEW

Extreme long positioning became net short, then partially rebuilt. July's price rebound **coincided with** less-negative managed-money positioning - consistent with covering and/or re-risking, not proof of causality. Physical normalization remains uncertain.



2024 PEAK TO 2026 TROUGH

-105,656

Contracts; 1.06m tonnes equivalent is not physical inventory.

JUNE TROUGH TO AUG 11

+16,417

Partial short-covering and/or re-risking; motive is not observed.

JULY PRICE VS Q1 2026

+42.6%

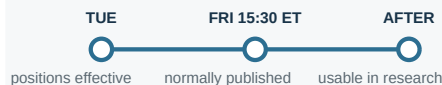
\$5.61/kg vs Jan-Mar mean \$3.933/kg; four-value retrospective extract.

CONDITIONAL EVENT-RISK POSTURE

Upside watch: crop recovery disappoints while positioning remains short and price holds. Confirm with less-negative net positioning, expanding open interest and weaker official crop/balance estimates.

Invalidate / downside: demand or grindings weaken, an official surplus grows, price rolls over or fresh shorts build with participation.

POINT-IN-TIME CONTROL



Real exception: Sep 30, 2025 positions were available 50 days later during the 2025 catch-up schedule. Actual delays are used where documented. Ordinary 2024 and uncovered 2025 dates are rule-modelled.

Sources: CFTC Futures-Only COT, cocoa code 073732; attributed CFTC publication-calendar extracts; four-value World Bank cocoa extract, source series attributed to ICCO. **Rights:** CFTC public domain; full upstream World Bank workbook/pages are not redistributed. Official URLs and upstream SHA-256 hashes: data/source_manifest.csv.

Historical research only. No causality, crowding, alpha, price forecast, executable futures P&L or physical-inventory equivalence. Current retrieved CFTC snapshots - not full value-vintage replay or latency-grade data. AI assisted review; deterministic Python produced every displayed number.